



higher education & training

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Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

MARKING GUIDELINE

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

INTRODUCTION TO COMPUTERS
NQF LEVEL 2

19 February 2026

This marking guideline consists of 5 pages.

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QUESTION 1

1.1 1.1.1 Logic gates are electronic circuits that perform logic operations on one or more input signals to produce an output signal. ✓✓ (2 × 1) (2)

1.1.2 Logic symbols are graphical representations to denote logic operations, inputs, and outputs in a logic circuit. ✓✓ (2 × 1) (2)

1.1.3 A truth table displays the output of a logic operation for all possible combinations of input values. ✓✓ (2 × 1) (2)

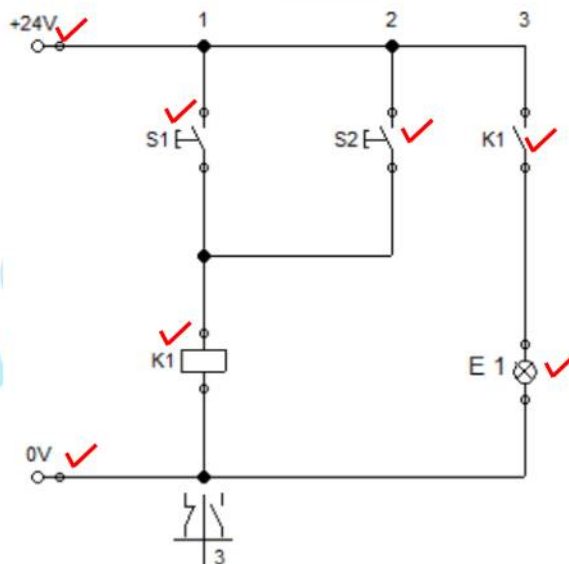
1.2 1.2.1 OR-gate ✓ (1)

1.2.2

X	Y	Z
0	0	0
0	1	1
1	0	1
1	1	1

(4 × 1) (4)

1.2.3



(7 × 1) (7)

1.3 1.3.1 "1" TRUE, HI (1)

1.3.2 "0" FALSE, LO (1)

1.4

Differences	Primary Memory	Secondary Memory
Volatility	A primary memory is volatile. ✓	A secondary memory is non-volatile. ✓
Access speed	Has a fast access speed. ✓	Has a slower access speed. ✓
Capacity	Has a limited capacity. ✓	Has a larger capacity. ✓
Function	Stores data temporarily. ✓	Stores data permanently.
Usage	Used to execute programs and store data temporarily. ✓	Used for storing a large amount of data. ✓

(5 × 2)

(10)

[30]

QUESTION 2

2.1

- Which physical connections to use. ✓
- How the connected computers should listen. ✓
- How to interrupt. ✓
- How to say goodbye. ✓

(4 × 1)

(4)

Layer 1: Physical transmits raw bits over a physical medium and enables communication between devices. ✓✓

Layer 2: Data link breaks data into frames for transmission. It also detects and corrects errors in frames. ✓✓

Layer 3: Network determines the best path for data transmission and assigns IP addresses to devices. ✓✓

Layer 4: Transport not only breaks down and reassembles data packets but also regulates data flow to prevent congestion. ✓✓

Layer 5: Besides managing the connection, session also sets up and tears down connections. It also establishes a connection between devices. ✓✓

Layer 6: Presentation translates data into a compatible format and encrypts it to ensure security. In addition, presentation compresses data to reduce transmission time. ✓✓

Layer 7: It not only supports email, file transfer, and web browsing but also enables communication between apps and network services. ✓✓

(7 × 2)

(14)

2.3

By way of either the hardware or the software or a combination of the two. ✓✓

(2)

2.4

A computer bus allows different components of a computer system to exchange data, instructions and control signals. ✓✓

(2)

- 2.5
- How to start and end a message. ✓
 - How to format a message. ✓
 - How to terminate a session or connection. ✓
 - How to detect unexpected loss of the connection, and what to do next.
 - Negotiates various connection characteristics.
 - What to do with a corrupted or improperly formatted message.
 - Detects the underlying physical connection or the existence of other end points or nodes.
- (Any 3 × 1) (3)
- [25]**

QUESTION 3

- 3.1 Runtime errors. ✓✓ (2)
- 3.2 When you are running an application and something causes it to fail. ✓✓ (2)
- 3.3 A program will alert you by opening a dialog box that reports the error, ✓ or if you are caught in an error and are unaware of it, the program will simply hang and not respond to your mouse clicks or keys strokes on the keyboard. ✓✓ (3 × 1) (3)
- 3.4 By pressing CTRL+ALT+DEL on your keyboard once. ✓✓ (2)
- 3.5 It will reboot the computer. ✓ 1 (1)
- 3.6 3.6.1 Faulty power supply to the computer fan. ✓ (1)
- 3.6.2
- Open the case of the computer. ✓
 - Unplug all the power supply cables from the various devices. ✓
 - Loosen the screws of the power supply at the back of the computer. Remove the power supply and replace it with a new one. ✓
 - Tighten the screws and re-plug all power cables to the appropriate devices. ✓
 - Close the case and switch on the computer. ✓
- (5 × 1) (5)
- 3.7
- Open the *My Documents* folder.
 - Select the file 'Year Plan 2025'.
 - *Right-click* on the file.
 - Select *Cut* in the drop-down menu.
 - Open the flash disk drive through *My Computer* or *Explorer*.
 - Right-click on the *flash disk*.
 - Select *Paste* from the menu.
 - Make sure the file is on the flash disk, then close the drive and make sure the file is no longer in the *My Documents* folder.
- (Any 5 × 1) (5)

- | | | | |
|-----|-------|---|-------------|
| 3.8 | 3.8.1 | Disk Cleanup is a utility to free up space on a computer's hard drive or solid-state drive by deleting unnecessary files and data on it. ✓✓ | (2) |
| | 3.8.2 | Compression reduces the size of files, making them easier to store, transmit, and share. It can also be used to encrypt data, making it more secure. ✓✓ | (2) |
| | | | [25] |

QUESTION 4

- | | | | |
|-----|---|------------|-------------|
| 4.1 | Shortcuts on a computer are keys or combinations of keys that allow you to perform specific tasks ✓ or actions quickly and efficiently. ✓ Because they reduce the need to use menus, icons or other navigation methods, ✓ shortcuts save you a great deal of time and improve your productivity ✓ (4 × 1) | | (4) |
| 4.2 | 4.2.1 | Ctrl + N ✓ | (1) |
| | 4.2.2 | Ctrl + X ✓ | (1) |
| 4.3 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Click on the Microsoft Office button and select <i>New</i>. ✓ • From the next menu, select <i>Blank document</i>. ✓ • Click on <i>Create</i>. ✓ • A new file can also be created with a shortcut key. ✓ (4 × 1) | | (4) |
| | | | [10] |

QUESTION 5

- | | | | |
|-----|--|--|-------------|
| 5.1 | Adding text involves inserting new text and creating new content in a slide. ✓✓ | | |
| | Whereas | | |
| | Formatting text involves modifying the appearance and layout of existing text. ✓✓ (2 × 2) | | (4) |
| 5.2 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Simple ✓✓ • Pleasing to the eyes • Avoid clutter • Create visual appeal (Any relevant answer) (2 × 1) | | (2) |
| 5.3 | Interactive presentation encourages audience engagement, ✓ participation, ✓ and feedback. ✓ (3 × 1) | | (3) |
| 5.4 | Uniform Resource Locator. ✓ | | (1) |
| | | | [10] |

TOTAL: 100